

BRUSSELS SPROUTS

Brassica oleracea Gemmifera Group

Love them or hate them, this distinctive tasting vegetable resists indifference. Sprouts have a delicious, sweet, nutty taste when picked and cooked young, and their flavor is enhanced if harvested after a frost. Try growing one of the more unusual purple or red types and interplant with fast-growing crops like lettuces, to make the most of your space.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Sprouts need a soil with a pH of at least 6.8, so apply some lime if necessary. Dig in some well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before planting, and ensure that the soil is firm—the plants will grow quite heavy and need to support their own weight. Make sure that you have rotated your crops and that you are not planting sprouts where brassicas have been grown in the last three years.

Sow seeds in trays or modules at a depth of .75 in (2 cm), or sow directly into the ground and protect with a cloche or fleece against frost. After about four or five weeks the seedlings should be ready to plant out. For fall or late winter crops, plant seedlings



Harvest sprouts from the bottom upward.

in early or mid-spring; for late summer–early fall crops, sow seeds under cover in winter and plant out in spring. Space large plants 24 in (60 cm) apart, and dwarf varieties 18 in (45 cm). Plant them deeply, with the lowest leaves touching the soil.

CROP CARE

Fit a brassica collar around the seedlings to deter cabbage root